Russell Dudek

AI & Automation Operator | Systems Integration | Operational Transformation

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linkedin.com/in/russelldudek · Candidate vision · Campaign repository

DELAWARE VALLEY COMPANIES · HEAD OF AI & AUTOMATION CANDIDATE

Hands-on operating systems builder for AI, automation, and integration.

Operator-technologist who makes complex work visible, connects business and technical teams, and builds operating mechanisms that turn emerging technology into adopted, measurable outcomes. Direct experience spans AI-enabled operations, ERP/workflow modernization, robotics and machine vision, high-reliability manufacturing, national logistics, and regulated field systems.

Workflow discovery & redesign	**ERP and system integration**	**AI / agentic workflow design**
Data visibility & dashboards	**Human review & governance**	**Adoption, standard work & QA**

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Vape-Jet · Director of Operations — 2025-Present

AI-first operating transformation in a software-enabled robotics and machine-vision business.

- Leads operating transformation across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows.
- Connects factory, field, customer, and machine-fleet signals into prioritized work, earlier risk detection, cleaner handoffs, dashboards, standard work, training, and accountability.
- Works directly in a business with approximately 1,000 fielded robots informing support and operating feedback loops.

DudeWorth · Founder / AI and Automation Advisor — 2017-Present

Hands-on workflow, readiness, agent, and operating-model design.

- Develops AI-readiness and opportunity frameworks assessing value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value.
- Designs agentic workflow patterns using structured context, retrieval, AI agents, human judgment, escalation, decision records, evaluation, and governance rails.
- Advises on AI-enabled operations, logistics technology, warehouse automation, AMRs, ASRS, cobots, transportation systems, network analysis, and workflow design.

Amazon · Operations Management / Site Leader — 2014-2018

Scaled customer-backward operating mechanisms in a 24/7 logistics environment.

- Led launch and execution for Amazon Prime Pittsburgh, supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.
- Built leadership routines, labor planning, throughput visibility, escalation paths, standard work, and operating mechanisms.
- Applied Lean and Gemba practices across safety, quality, throughput, customer experience, and team engagement; contributed to Prime Air research and Amazon Flex geolocation concepts.

Compunetics · Director of Operations and Engineering Management — 2000-2013

High-reliability engineering, manufacturing, quality, and customer delivery.

- Progressed through R&D program management, production management, strategic acquisition, operations management, and director-level leadership.
- Led engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and complex technical programs; built quality systems, root-cause practices, performance measures, and process controls.
- Collaborated with high-consequence customers and partners including DoD, CERN, Intel, and AMD.

OPERATING METHOD

1 · Observe	**2 · Clarify**	**3 · Connect**	**4 · Instrument**
Follow the work, artifacts, exceptions, timing, and user burden.	Name authority, outcome ownership, service ownership, and escalation.	Link authoritative records and system boundaries before adding AI.	Baseline flow, handling, completeness, exceptions, adoption, and reliability.

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ADDITIONAL OPERATING EXPERIENCE

Cardinal Building Products · Regional Director 2021-2023

- Built the company's first remote regional operation.
- Modernized distributed customer, CRM, commercial, fulfillment, logistics, digital marketing, SEO, and online-buying workflows.
- Advanced AI-enhanced transportation-management and route-planning concepts.

ZeusVu · Chief Pilot, Autonomous Systems and Aerial Data Operations 2018-2022

- Led regulated drone operations across medical, energy, logistics, real-estate, and restricted-airspace contexts with a 100% safety record and no FAA incidents.
- Developed TensorFlow-based concepts for automated aerial inventory and computer-vision-enabled field intelligence.
- Designed medical drone delivery and chain-of-custody concepts connecting technology, risk, stakeholders, and governed execution.

Enviro Social Capital · Chairman of the Board 2014-2017

- Co-founded and led a public-private initiative focused on sustainable infrastructure, green finance, and civic transformation.
- Helped shape and evaluate a $200 million Social Impact Bond feasibility concept for Pittsburgh sewage and green-infrastructure improvement.

IEEE · CMPT and EDS Pittsburgh Chapter Chair 2012-2016

- Led regional technology programming connecting industry, academia, STEM outreach, electronics, manufacturing, and emerging technology.

TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

Agentic AI · LLM workflows · RAG patterns · Human-in-the-loop design · Python · SQL · JavaScript · TensorFlow · Tableau · ERP/Odoo workflows · Jira · Confluence · HubSpot · Slack · GIS and mapping workflows

EDUCATION

University of Pittsburgh
Bachelor of Science
Academic grounding in materials science, physical chemistry, and biology-related studies.

CREDENTIALS

- Google AI Essentials
- IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner
- Six Sigma Certification
- OSHA 10

ROLE-SPECIFIC OPERATING POSTURE

Start with the work. Observe estimating, project management, field coordination, and exceptions on-site before designing the workflow.

Build the smallest useful mechanism. Connect accountable records and system boundaries before adding AI.

Instrument from launch. Track cycle time, manual handling, completeness, exception age, adoption, and reliability.

HONEST TRANSFERABILITY

Direct NetSuite, Power Automate, SharePoint, and Graph API production ownership is not asserted here. The transferable evidence is hands-on ERP/workflow modernization, programming and data tools, integration-oriented operating design, and rapid learning inside complex operational environments.

SELECTED OPERATING MECHANISMS

Cross-system visibility

Connects production, purchasing, quality, support, engineering issue flow, CRM, ERP, collaboration tools, and telemetry into visible work, priorities, handoffs, and accountability.

AI readiness and control

Frames opportunities through value, feasibility, data readiness, adoption burden, human authority, evaluation, governance, reuse, escalation, and time-to-value.

Quality and reliability

Uses root cause, process control, standard work, performance measures, traceability, failure review, and explicit recovery paths in high-consequence technical environments.

Distributed operations

Builds mechanisms across remote regions, national logistics, field systems, regulated airspace, GIS, route planning, chain-of-custody, and customer-facing work.

Adoption through use

Pairs workflow design with direct observation, user feedback, training, visual management, clear ownership, and routines that displace workarounds rather than merely launch tools.

Builder-to-team transition

Starts with direct mechanism-building, documents what works, exposes the operating portfolio, and uses real workload and capability gaps to define the team that follows.